

FILM REVIEW

RAAT GAYI BAAT GAYI

Small is Painful

RATING ★☆☆☆☆

Starring: Rajat Kapoor, Neha Dhupia, Vinay Pathak**Director:** Saurabh Shukla

What's worse than big budget non-sense? Small budget rubbish disguising itself as a cerebral comedy of coitus interruptus. What promised to be a delicious sex romp, with Neha Dhupia's willowy back and Rajat Kapoor's bared torso, turns out to be a dreary reality check on why good Indians indulge in bad sex. Just as the wife (Iravarti Harshe) seems to be getting involved with the highly fanciable artist (Aamir Bashir, delish), she stops short. Just as it seems that Dhupia and Kapoor's flirtation

will lead to some hi-jinks bedroom activity, again the film stops short. All the C-Company clowns are present and in good form, from Ranvir Shorey as the irritating chef just back from Australia who wants to start a chain of restaurants in India, called Flying Kukkad, to sad sack Vinay Pathak, who spends a large part of his life watching porn on his wife's computer. But it's a bedroom farce where the doors shut rudely in the viewers' faces. Far too soon. **KB**



(L TO R) PATHAK, KAPOOR AND DHUPIA

IF YOU HAVE 90 MINUTES, go watch *If I Were King*, an opera presentation by the Neemrana Music Foundation at Delhi's Siri Fort Auditorium on January 12 at 7 p.m.

ARTEHIBITION

A Sacred CANVAS

As a child, painter Jaysri Burman, 49, would listen to her father chanting mantras from the Ramayana and the Mahabharata. Over the years, characters like Ravana or Sita found expression in her paintings. This mid-career retrospective of Burman will exhibit works from the early period of her career till the present time. With the help of vibrant colours, she proceeds to



A WORK BY BURMAN

locate her tales in a space of secular idioms, where they no longer remain deities but come together to form tales of myth, legend, fable and allegory. A graduate of the Visual College of Art, Kolkata, Burman's themes deal with the empowerment of women through popular images of Hinduism.

"I have been inspired by a variety of incarnations of Shakti or the female energy—Ganga, Yamuna and Saraswati," she says. On January 14 at the Lalit Kala Akademi, Delhi and on January 23 at Art Alive Gallery, Delhi.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

MUSIC REVIEWS

Masterly MIXES

COLOURS
Saregama Rs 199

The album *Colours* divides its compilation into different genres of music, Sufi,

ghazal and bhajan, for the listener. Listen to the late Ustad Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan and his nephew Rahat Fateh Ali Khan with A.R. Rahman for some scintillating Sufi music. Ghazals include Ghulam Ali's *Chupke chupke*, Bhupinder Singh's *Dil dhundta hai* and Jagjit Singh's *Baat niklegi to phir door talak jayegi*. With tracks rendered by master artistes, the album is a must buy.

SHADES—ASHA EK RANG
ANEK Saregama Rs 500

The four-CD compilation has been put together according to the moods of the songs by evergreen

diva Asha Bhosle. The first CD, *Asha Ki Chhed Chhaad*, features naughty, vivacious songs like *O mere sona re sona re*, *Bhanwara bada naadan hai* and *Koi sharabi babu* among others. The second CD titled *Asha ki Shokhiyan* is a compilation of irresistible seductive numbers like *Aaiye meharbaan* and *Raat akeli hai*. Listen to ghazals in *Asha ka Shaiyarana Andaz* and sentimental songs in the fourth compilation. The albums prove why archival music can still set the pace.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit